



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE
May 2023

#5

COMING EVENTS

MAY

2-5th National Rally
10th Committee Meeting
17th Lunch at Kangaroo Valley
24th Slot Shop

JUNE

1st Monthly Meeting
3rd Cent Coast W'shop
7th Committee Meeting
10th Sydney W'shop
24/25th Rose Cafe, Goulburn

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Visit to the New South Wales Rail Museum at Thirlmere - 23 April 2023

By Denis Kasza.

Wonderful that 33 members and visitors gathered for the club run to the Thirlmere Railway Museum on Sunday 23rd April. The Sydney contingent met at Partridge VC Rest Area, Menangle from 10am, departing at 10.30. The Illawarra and Southern members met at Wollongong and Bomaderry, with all convoys converging on Thirlmere at around 11am. Susie Doctor, who had never ridden in an Austin-Healey, was given a ride from Partridge VC by the gallant Peter Laurantus.

Some members chose to travel on the steam locomotive from Thirlmere to Buxton return and to take in the museum later. The 1954 Royal Tour Train was a highlight, with its very luxurious furnishings and surprisingly small beds.

A congenial pub lunch with friends old and new wound up the day at around 3pm.

Participating were: Ross and Jenny Penman (BJ8), Peter Laurantus (BJ8), David and Julie Tattam (BJ8), Glenn and Kim Hogan (BJ7), Robert and Anne Sassall (BT7), Robert Hoskin (BJ8), Mark Righini (BJ8), David McIntyre (BJ8) with Charlie Cuglay. Present in their BJ9s were Joe Armour and Peter Armour, George and Liz Goodare, John and Fran Thornton, Chris and Lynn Fitzpatrick, Bryan Levy, Greg and Kathy Barnsley, John and Yonica Macey with friends Graham and Jennifer MacGraw, Bruce and Pauline Lester with Joan Turner. Also Susie Doctor and Denis Kasza, Austin A99 Westminster (the closest to a BJ9 you can get).



POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhaealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhaealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

No meeting this month as the NSW AHOC hosts the National Rally in the Hunter. I'm looking forward to seeing some of our members, but also catching up with Austin-Healey owners from interstate. Unfortunately, due to various circumstances the numbers will be smaller than previous rallies, but I'm sure that the program that has been put together by our Rally Committee will provide a good balance of getting out and seeing the scenery and socialising with the others attending.

Australian Austin-Healey Magazine Issue 34

You should have all received the latest edition of the Australian Austin-Healey magazine and having skimmed the pages am looking forward to perusing it in greater depth during one of my regular visits to Tasmania, as I usually do of late. There are even a few letters to the editor to create



some discussion which you might have some thought on. It was a bit scary to see the references to Christmas parties as they seemed so long ago, but in reality, not so.

I'm not able to attend a lot of these events, but it's great to see the reports and photos that appear in Flat Chat and the Australian Austin-Healey.

Social Events and Chapters

It's great to see that following the Covid exclusion period, events are being organised for members to take their cars out and to get together for a bit of socialising not only in Sydney but also in the regional areas of NSW. Due to distance and a whole lot of other things that need to be done (yes being retired does take up a whole lot more time than pre-retirement)

Speaking of photos, Ian Richter has provided me with hundreds of photos that he downloaded from the Internet of Austin-Healeys in different locations and conditions which I will endeavour to show as a prelude and postscript at our general meetings. What struck me about some of the old photos was the rough terrain and conditions that Austin-Healeys were put

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COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
Wyoming NSW 2250
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
0421 598 755
hedli@tpg.com.au

Treasurer - Jenny Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Social Secretary - Bruce Ewan
bruce.ewan1@gmail.com
Assisted by Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

Editor - Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Rd.,
Kurrajong Heights 2758
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p.cquinn@outlook.com

Historian - Joe Armour
0419 233 099
joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Storton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the May 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I hope that everyone will find something of interest within its digital pages.

Now here is something you are unlikely to find in any Austin-Healey publication throughout the world. We are giving away with every single copy of the May Flat Chat Newsletter an Austin-Healey absolutely free. It's a BJ7 and it can be yours in any colour you want. Turn to page 26 for your own 3000 BJ7.

So what's in this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter? Rest assured the minutes and normal committee reports are there to be read. It's pleasing to say that plenty is happening within the AHOC NSW. By the time you receive this missive quite a few members will have left for the Hunter Valley for the National Rally and I am sure I speak for everyone to wish them a wonderful time. Surely next month we will be able to read all about it.

There are not one, but two reports on the Club's recent visit to the NSW Rail Museum at Thirlmere. Thank you to those like John Thornton who put their fingers to the keyboard. There is also a report of the auction in the US of an historic Healey Silverstone that had seen plenty of competition and approaching that there is a bunch of photos for the days of the BMC Competitions Department.

You would think that putting back together the Quinn Austin-Healey for the umpteenth time would be as easy as falling off a log. Well, it's not and after falling from a ladder a year or so back I am keeping away from logs too. The throttle linkages are a challenge, consisting of rods, pulleys and a bell-crank that came for a 100 many years ago. It's one of those jobs with an Austin-Healey that calls for patience

that is not always available. Then there is the generator that had to be painted a number of times as the paint kept bubbling. Probably due to the frank and open words I had with the bloke in Bunnings, about the differences between Semi-Gloss Black and Satin Black. The generator is also cantankerous and is refusing to play along by not fitting. Will have to explore different adjusting brackets.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Thanks again to Ian Richter who is keeping us appraised as to the progress with his 100 BN1. You can read about it on page 24. Please if you are doing some work to your car, let your fellow members know by sending in a few words and perhaps a photo or two relevant to the story. Remember to rush to page 26 for your own BJ7.



Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**

DONALD HEALEY BIRTHDAY DISPLAY DAY 2023



Please join us on Sunday **2 JULY 2023**

At the Bowling Green, Parramatta Park
(Located near the main entry at the corner of Macquarie & Pitt Streets Parramatta)
From 10am until 3.30pm

A barbecue lunch and soft drinks will be provided, just bring a chair and your car.

Donald Healey was born on 3 July 1898 and throughout his lifetime was involved with the development of Healey, Austin-Healey, Riley, Alvis, Triumph, Jensen, Humber, Nash, Invicta and Austin marques.

The Austin-Healey Owners Club would like to celebrate DMH's birthday with a gathering of many cars of the above marques as possible.

For further information, please contact Ross on 0408 465 547 or email us at enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 6 April 2023

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

Meeting commenced at 7:40pm.

ATTENDEES

There were 24 members present (refer attendance list for details).

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

N/A

APOLOGIES

Chris Dimmock, Bruce Ewan, Mal French, Gordon & Louise Lynas, Patrick & Caroline Quinn, Don Read, Neville Stirton, Ron Strange.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 2 March 2023, as published in the April 2023 issue of Flat Chat, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Jim reported on the activities from the various chapters. All were going well, however the Central West chapter was keen to recruit some more members, so they were going to write to Austin-Healey owners in the district who weren't Club members.

Jim had also visited the Zed Car Club to see how they ran hybrid meetings. They had the benefit of some younger more tech-oriented members, but despite that, Jim was keen to try a hybrid meeting, potentially for the June meeting.

Jim also passed on the very sad news that Club member Philip Bloom had passed away on 27 March.

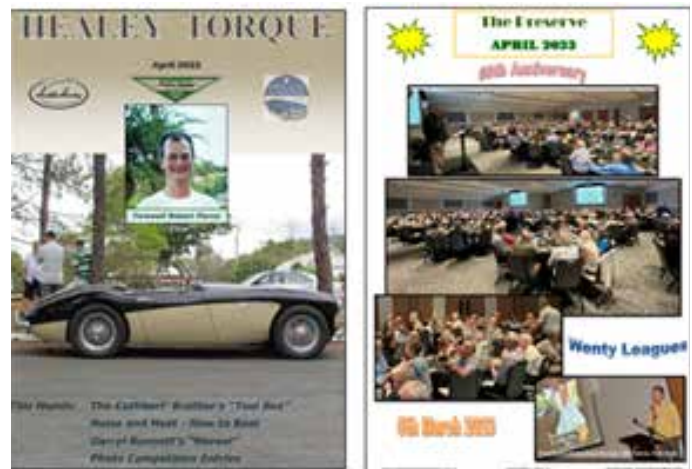
VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Geoff suggested that each meeting feature a discussion on some kind, e.g. what oils members were using in their cars. This led to an entertaining discussion on that very topic!

Geoff added that he was happy to investigate a topic if people were interested.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie reported on the usual magazines received from other car clubs.



Other emails included Shannons offering a trip to Goodwood (plus a funny-looking motorcycle) for one lucky policyholder and The Quarters Boutique Hotel at Forresters Beach was offering a mid-week accommodation special.



The most interesting of the spam emails had come from a company called Genbrain with the header "Many people experience 'senior moments' by age 50". Not that this would apply to anyone in the Club... Apparently Genbrain had a "premium brain health supplement" which would "improve our brains naturally" and it was doctor recommended!

TREASURER'S REPORT

Jenny reported on funds held as at 31 March 2023. (See over page)

Jenny also advised that the Club now had a credit card facility available, but noted that this would incur a surcharge of 2.2% of the value of the transaction.



☐ Main account	\$27,245.63
☐ Biggest item was spent on regalia	\$2,176.90
☐ \$9,362.44 in the National Rally Account	
☐ Received \$330.00 in membership	
☐ Paid \$150 in Assn Fees - Combined Sports Car Assn	
☐ Paid \$240 for Rental of Post Office Box	
☐ Paid \$550 for Website	
☐ Term Deposit	\$70,000.00
☐ Cash Reserve Account	\$21,996.95
☐ Charlies Run Account	\$1,844.09
☐ and we have	\$361.73 available in Debit Card

SOCIAL SECRETARIES' REPORT

Denis provided an update on Bruce's recovery from his nasty bicycle accident, then went through the social schedule for the next few months. Contrary to the update at the March meeting, apparently the All British Day was now going ahead at The King's School, on 17 September.

Greg Strange also mentioned the Shannons Eastern Creek event to be held 20 August. Tickets were \$25 and the Club needed to fill in a form to get tickets, so it was proposed that people should pay up front.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Pamela had been busy sending cards to Ian & Jenny Richter (for hosting the March CC chapter workshop), Alan Mitchell (ill health), John & Judy Sherman (a beautiful grandchild!), Jeff Burton (bereavement), Philip Bloom's family, and Mal French (injury). Mal contacted the club, expressing thanks.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim reported that the admin features on the website were being updated and he would be creating new pages for each of the Club chapters

MEMBERSHIP

Christine advised of a new Member – Neil Mason (1965 3000 Mk III Phase 2) and a new Associate Member John Carrall (1972 Toyota Landcruiser). Lincoln & Karina Sell had also rejoined the Club.

Christine reminded members to email any contact detail changes to membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

[com.au](mailto:membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au) even if they had already updated their details on the website.

RALLY REPORT

In Gordon's absence, John provided an update on the Rally, noting that 137 attendees had signed up for a fantastic event.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Flat Chat had been sent out the previous evening.

REGISTRAR

No Report

HISTORIAN

No Report

LIBRARIAN

No Report

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/SPARE PARTS

Courtesy of a recent experience he'd had in his workshop, Greg reminded everyone that if they made modifications to a car, to make notes so that the person fixing it knows what they're looking at!

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross advised that he'd been in contact with Paramatta Park and all was on track for the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day on 2 July.

CMC REPORT

Greg advised that there was apparently a limit of 20 cars per club for the Shannons Day.

Someone at the CMC meeting had also told the story of a recent St Ives Coffee & Cars where the cops had parked outside and caught some people who hadn't filled in their log book. It was suggested that something be added to the Club's constitution about recognising events from other car clubs and that this could be discussed more at the next general meeting.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

As previously mentioned, the All British Day was going to be held on 17 September at The Kings School.

CSCA REPORT

Colin provided a wrap up of the action from the Phillip Island meeting a few weeks previously.



In other motorsport-related news, the owner of Pheasant Wood Circuit, Steve Shelley, was now the new owner of Wakefield Park, so that would be reopening at some point.

REGALIA

Hot off the (clothes) presses, Colin had a range of

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

A quiet month with no new members.

If you have any changes to your details please don't forget to email me so that we can ensure that the clubs records are up-to-date. You can also change them on the website yourself using your login and password to access.

We also have the Square facility to pay for your membership, and we also have the smart new purchases

through, contrast to the way that they are now cared for and only driven on sealed roads. Compare some of the photos from page 52 of the latest Australian Austin-Healey with those on other pages to see what I mean.

Hybrid meetings

I've mentioned this in the past and at the last committee meeting it was decided to give it a trial for six months. The meetings will be run over Zoom and start with the June meeting. So those who are not able to attend our monthly meetings at Strathfield (yes those of you who are belong to the regional

fantastic new clobber, with hats for \$20, polo shirts for \$40 and shirts for \$75 (cash prices – credit card payment would need to add 2.2%). These were so popular on the night that Colin was already planning on ordering more!



Alan Mitchell made the point that the Club's website had now been going for 20 years and it was amazing to see how it had evolved to what we had today.

GENERAL BUSINESS

Everyone was reminded that there would be no General Meeting in May because of the National Rally.

Meeting concluded at 9.10pm.

that regalia has, there are dress shirts, polo shirts and bucket hats and many were sold at the April meeting. So get in quick before they all go.

The 49th National Rally is to be held at the Hunter Valley from 2 to 5 May 2023. So we hope all the participants enjoy a great time there and safe travels to and from.

With no May meeting I look forward to seeing you all at an event soon or the June general meeting.

Happy Healeying

Christine Lyttle

chapters of the club) mark your calendar to dial in on 1st June to be part of the meeting. A link to the meeting together with the meeting ID and password will be included in the email that brings you your June edition of Flat Chat.

If you aren't familiar with Zoom click on the provided link and it will show you the login page that you will receive the details for with Flat Chat. Join Meeting658 – Zoom.

Jim Phillips

President

Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com
Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

The National Rally being held in the Hunter Valley dominates this month's activities. Even if you have not booked for the Rally there is the opportunity to come along for the display day, meet owners from other states and have a fantastic experience amongst the beauty of the Hunter Valley. The location for the display is the Hunter Valley Gardens, 2090 Broke Rd, Pokolbin NSW 2320 on Wednesday 3rd May starting at 10am.

It is really great to see increasing attending numbers at AHOC NSW events. Recent events have all had good attendance, and as a result the number and diversity of social activities offered can be increased.

We are working on creating events that will appeal to broader audiences, with geographic regions, south north, east and west to be catered for. Runs that cover greater geographic regions and distances have been organised that will appeal all involved and are not only creating wonderful memories and experiences for those involved but helping to connect members and create new friends.

There is an intention to organise club events that will

cater to all members, so if you have suggestions, please feel free to get in touch with either Denis or myself and we will try and put together an event we will where possible create an experience or event to cater for you and other members.

In case you don't know, there is no Central Coast Chapter workshop on May 6th.

Release your Inner Child!

Life presents opportunities. Walking along an unfamiliar road, through an unfamiliar suburb, my attention was on the car yard ahead, before it was dragged into a large double fronted warehouse building.

Inside a cavernous space, the whine of a Lola T600 at full pace dominated. A multi-tiered racetrack was presented.... the Scalextric dream for many.

Beyond the first room, two further huge tracks, eight cars wide each, provide greater opportunities to test racing prowess, strategy, fortitude, dynamics and physics.

On Wednesday 24 May there will be three huge race-tracks, a wide diversity of cars, plus indoor picnic table and facilities are available. Whilst not essential, please feel free to bring along food and drinks. See below!



Social Report Cont'

Content from other events and chapters following.

Event: National Rally - Hunter Valley

Date: Tuesday 2 May to Friday 5 May

Address: Chateau Elan, Vintage Dr, Rothbury NSW 2320

**Event: Lunch in Kangaroo Valley**

Date: Wednesday 17 May 2023

Time: 11:00 am, in Kangaroo Valley to explore and shop

Lunch: 12.30pm in The Friendly Inn Hotel, 159 Moss Vale Rd, Kangaroo Valley NSW 2577

Cost: Up to you

Register: Let the above know.

Event: Slot Shop

Date: Wednesday 24 May 2023

Time: 6:00pm

Address: 293 Princes Highway, Arncliffe

Cost: \$23 for the first hour including hired car (\$16

if you bring your own compatible Scalextric car)
<http://www.slotshop.com.au>

Register: PLEASE register in advance through the above.

This is a paid event, where staff need to be on hand, therefore there is a need to register in advance and attend where you have prebooked.

Event: Central Coast Chapter Technical Day

Date: Saturday June 3, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber NSW 2251

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc

Event: Sydney Technical Day – Greg Strange Motor Mechanic

Date: Saturday June 10, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 117 Cleveland, Darlington

Topic: Working on the BMC Production Line in Sydney.

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc

Register: PLEASE register in advance to the above.

Event: Overnight run to the Rose Cafe, Goulburn

Date: June 24/25, 2023

Stay: Trappers Motel (Mercure)

Visit: Goulburn Rail Museum - Heritage House.

Details: Contact above social secretaries

FOR SALE**FOR SALE****FOR SALE**

Neville Stirton has a bunch of Austin-Healey things for sale such as a set of exhaust manifolds for a 3000 Mk2 Roadster. You can reach Neville on 0414 472 877.

Yes I had to ask. Exhaust manifolds for the triple SU 3000 are unique to the model.

The June meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 1st at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Come along from 5.30pm and enjoy dinner in the bistro with your fellow club members.

Chapter News

AHOC Mid-North Coast Chapter Gathering – Saturday 22nd April 2023 By Phil Lorking

Present:- Tony Ash, Allan and Di Bryson, Chris and Lyn Hatch, Simon Lorking and Phil and Anthea Lorking.

Chris and Lyn arrived in a 1275 LS Mini Clubman which had never been road registered and only had 900 Ks on the odometer and recently went past 1,400 Ks. Not often do you get to see an as new 45 year old motor car.

Al Bryson mentioned a friend who had recently purchased a new coil and on fitting it had the distributor points burn out after a short period. Although the coil was marked 12-volt, it appears that it required a ballast resistor. Not all manufacturers are indicating this on the coil or packaging.

As a consequence, Chris Hatch informed the throng of how to establish and test your new coil.

AHOC Southern Region Chapters NSW Rail Museum - Thirlmere – 23rd April 2023 By John Thornton



Just as I sit down to write my report on the Thirlmere Train Museum excursion, I can hear a steam train blowing the whistle as it passes though Wollongong. A reminder of a great day. Rob and Anne Sassall, I'm sure you heard it too.

This month our Southern Region Chapters joined the AHOC's main social event for the month at Thirlmere. Thirteen members and nine friends turned out from the southern regions for a great day. In total there was 33 members and friends there on the

Using a multimeter check the ohms across the two low voltage conductors on the coil. (Ballasted coils are used on more modern vehicles)

- A resistance of 3 ohms is a non-ballasted coil.
- A resistance of 1.5 ohms is for a coil requiring a ballast resistor.

To check the high-tension circuit a good coil should read 9,000 ohms when connecting your multimeter's leads from the battery side of the coil to the high tension output.

Note:- Prior to making this test, you should touch the multimeter leads together to establish the resistance of the leads and subtract this from the test reading.

Further discussions followed on Tony Ash's recent purchase of the John and Kate Burch 3000 Mk2 Roadster. Tony requested a little help on a different view of a couple items with the car. Simon and I went to view and supply our expertise (?) and manpower for a couple of hours.

day and their details can be found in Denis Kasza's report on page 1.

Most of us agreed that it had been many years since any of us had visited the Museum. The improvements to facilities and train displays are just amazing and I need another day to take it all in.



AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

What is missing from this photo?



It's your CAR!!

I like the idea of Austin-Healeys photographed in interesting and historic locations.

Now, go and look at your diary and
tell me you are available for a pleasant luncheon at:



The Friendly Inn at Kangaroo Valley
Wednesday 17th May 2023
11:00am in the Valley to walk and shop.
Lunch in the pub at 12:30.

Plenty of parking behind the pub.

Photos on the bridge after lunch.

John Thornton:
Mobile: 0419 266 284
Email: john.thornton2011@outlook.com



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

With the Hunter Valley National Rally getting underway in a few days, it is perhaps appropriate to remind members with cars on Conditional Registration when they should make an entry in their vehicle logbook.

As most would probably know the logbook for your car provides you with personal usage for 60 days within the 12 months registration period. Such usage is in addition to AHOC events and yes the National Rally is an AHOC event. What this means that if you attend the Rally in your conditionally registered car, you don't need to touch the logbook.

HOWEVER! And this is a big one, you need to travel

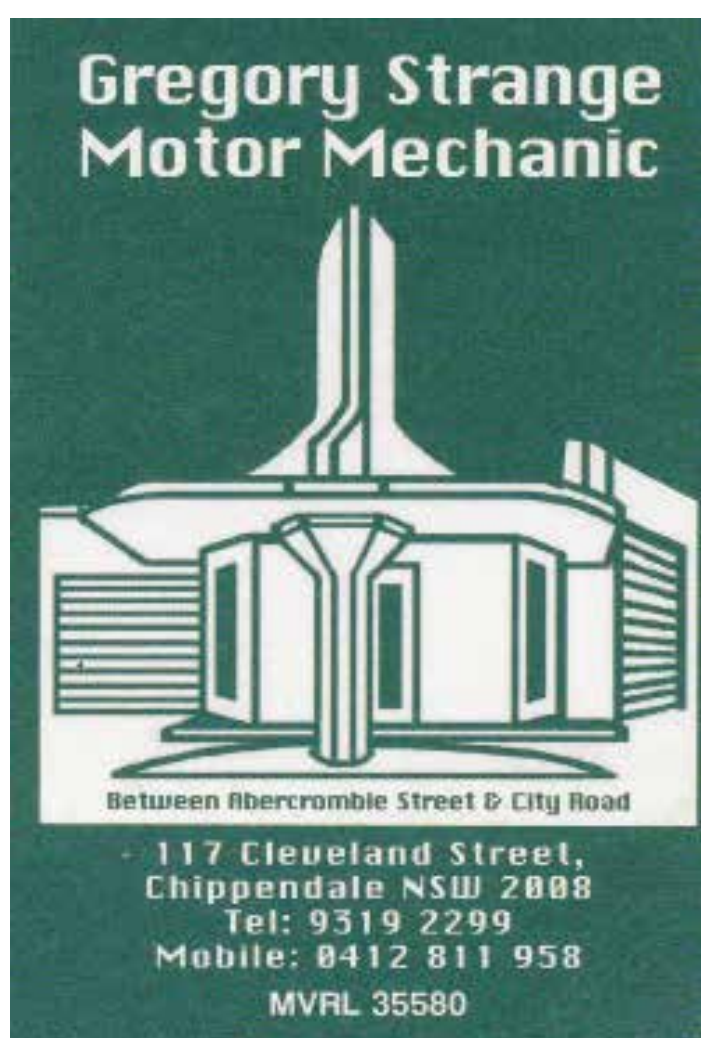
directly from where your car is normally garaged (usually your home address) to the National Rally venue. While at the Rally you can drive around and attend the various outings and events without having to make an entry in the logbook. Following of course, the return journey home is the same as far as the logbook is concerned.

What happens if you wish to not travel directly? You have received a call from Aunt Joan or the grandchildren in Newcastle beckon. The answer is straightforward, as it's likely to be a detour away from the direct route to and from. For any detour away from the most direct route you will need to make an entry in your vehicle's logbook. If you don't and you receive a "Pull over driver!" be prepared for some lightening of your bank account. Even worse, should unfortunately you have an accident while on an unrecorded detour, you are likely to have some explaining to do to your insurer as well as the police.

By the way, to show that you are attending a club event, best to carry something indicating that the National Rally is occurring, perhaps a printed copy of Flat Chat.

Again, the necessary renewal steps are indicated below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

AHOC SOUTHERN REGION CHAPTERS LOOK OUT FOR THIS IN JUNE FAIRGROUND FOLLIES



Do you want to re-live your youth? **YES, YES, YES!!**, I hear you all say.
Well, come with me, open your mind to the past and I will have you re-living your
“Childhood” from the minute you walk into this amazing private collection
located in the Southern Highlands.

**FAIRGROUND FOLLIES IS A 100 YEAR OLD
FULLY OPERATIONAL FAIRGROUND EXPERIENCE**

- This event is a two hour tour of the entire historic exhibition, with morning tea.
- The tour and morning tea is \$38.00 per person.
- Full details in next month's Flat Chat Newsletter.
- Get ready to jump in QUICK with your booking.

John Thornton:
Mobile: 0419 266 284
Email: john.thornton2011@outlook.com



Robert Hoskin, Bryan Levy, Lynn Fitzpatrick, Susie Doctor, Denis kasza, Chris Fitzpatrick, Julie Tattam, David Tattam

FOR SALE

FOR SALE

FOR SALE



Frederique Constant Geneve Healey
Limited Edition Watch
Never Been Worn.

In presentation box with highly collectable
model 100S NOJ 393

Absolutely no mileage on the clock
The motor has never been turned over.

Bill Metcalf
0447 010 145

US Racing Royalty

by Patrick Quinn

It's not often a Healey Silverstone with such impeccable racing history comes up for sale.

In case you didn't know, just 105 Healey Silverstones were built on two differing chassis – the D and E type chassis. Actually, to the normal eye the chassis looks the same, but there is more room in the E type Silverstone. This 1949 Healey Silverstone is one of 51 built on the D type chassis. Chassis D19 is said to have been the second Silverstone to arrive in the US after being purchased new by Kimberly-Clark (loo paper, disposable nappies, tissues etc) heir Jim Kimberly for use in Sports Car Club of America competition. He kept it for two years before selling it to Fred Wacker who contin-

ued to race it. Names that perhaps don't mean much to us here in Australia, but quite significant and revered from the early days of US sports car racing.

Apart from two Silverstones, one fitted with a Cadillac V8 and the other a Nash straight-six, D19 like other real Healeys was fitted with the Riley "Big Four" 2,443cc inline-four featuring dual camshafts mounted high in the engine block, a detachable cylinder head with 90° overhead valves and hemispherical combustion chambers, a counter-weighted crankshaft, an alloy sump and twin SU carburettors.

Also, as with other Riley powered Healeys, the Sil-



verstone is fitted with the Riley four-speed manual transmission with synchromesh on the top three gears. Trailing-link independent front suspension incorporates coil springs and lever-arm hydraulic shock absorbers, while the coil-sprung solid axle at the rear utilises telescopic shocks and a Panhard rod. Stopping is by finned alloy drums all around, with duplex actuation at the front wheels.

The sale was through the on-line auction system Bring

a Trailer starting at US\$1,949 (Au\$2,944). Nine days later it was at US\$110,000 (Au\$166,000) and the following day the reserve was met. Bring a Trailer allows watchers to make comments on the car and the auction itself. These were coming in thick and fast, predominantly showing the general lack of knowledge amongst observers on the Warwick built Healeys.

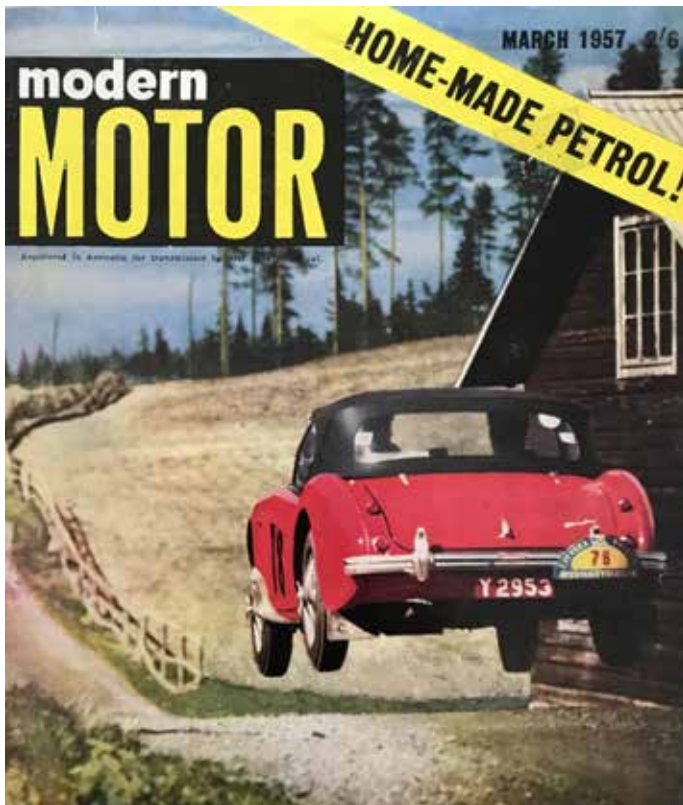
In the early hours in Australia of Saturday April 22nd the car was sold for US\$162,000 or Au\$245,000.

JUN
24



ROSE CAFE GOULBURN

**24/25th June. Option to
stay overnight. Brunch at
Rose Cafe 11am Sunday
June 25th, followed by
visit to Goulburn Rail
Museum/ Heritage House
RSVP Denis Kasza
0407492008**



While I have seen the photo before, only now have I noticed that fitted to the car were a few dealer supplied extras. Behind the front wheels there are chrome plated metal mud deflectors while there are rubber flaps behind the rear. If you look closely at the exhaust you will see it's fitted with a shell shape extension. Interesting things to be fitted to a car taking part in a rally. PQ

It Jumped out at Me in Kangaroo Valley!!!

By John Thornton

I put this photo up on Facebook, mainly out of interest as it was an old magazine.

The responses tell me that no matter how old the photo is or where it was taken, i.e. the other side of the world, someone can always add more interesting information to make the story.

This is what I received:

Anders Gustafson:

The picture is from the Swedish 'Rally to the Midnight Sun'. Possibly 1956. Fun part is that the car has red interim registration plates, which was standard for new cars before given ordinary numbers. Indicates that the car is brand new. Letter Y was given to cars registered in the region around Sundsvall in the northern part of Sweden.

Clas Arleskar:

This is the 1956 Midnight Sun Rally and Lindberg/Frolander in Austin Healey 100. Lindburgh also owned the 100S #3705 at the time.

Kjell Bengtsson:

Y-Regard. It's up here in Vasternorrland. Don't know more about the owner/driver.



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PAINTED SILOS TOUR - 4th to 8th September 2023 - Itinerary

Monday - SEPTEMBER 4th

Depart Sydney
Travel to HARDEN MURRUMBURRAH
Silo location – Neill Street, Harden

Continue to GRENFELL

Silo location – 30 West Street, Grenfell

Continue to WEST WYALONG for overnight stay at either:-

CAMEO MOTEL, 263 Neeld Street, \$120/night, 6 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2255

Or

COLONIAL MOTOR INN, 4 Ungarie Road, \$ 130/night, 10 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2611

TOTAL 530 KMS FOR DAY



Grenfell



Harden



Weethallie

Tuesday - SEPTEMBER 5th

Depart West Wyalong to WEETHALLIE

Silo location – Railway Street, Weethallie

Continue travel on to DUBBO for overnight stay at

BLUE DIAMOND MOTOR INN, 113/115 Wingewarra Street, \$150/night, 10 Queen, 5 Twin rooms

Phone (02) 6882 0666

TOTAL 380 KMS FOR DAY



Dunedoo



Quirindi



Merriwa

Wednesday - SEPTEMBER 6th

Depart Dubbo to DUNEDOO

Silo location – Castlereagh Highway, Dunedoo

Continue to MERRIWA

Silo location – Hackets Road, Merriwa

Continue to QUIRINDI via SCONE

Silo location – Quirindi

Overnight stay at BEST WESTERN MOTEL/RSL, \$148/night, two people

Phone (02) 6746 1995

TOTAL 340 KMS FOR DAY



Barraba



Gunnedah

Thursday - SEPTEMBER 7th

Depart Quirindi to BARRABA,

Silo location – Manilla Road, Barraba

Continue travel to GUNNEDAH

Silo location – 2 Barber Street, Gunnedah

Overnight stay at the HARVEST LODGE MOTEL, 404 Conadilly Street, \$160 for night, 2 people

Phone: (02) 6742 3400

TOTAL 260 KM FOR DAY

Friday - SEPTEMBER 8th

Depart Gunnedah to PORTLAND

Silo location – William Street, Portland

NO MOTEL ORGANISED, SOME MAY WISH TO TRAVEL HOME.

IF NOT, BOOK A MOTEL

TOTAL 350 KMS FOR DAY TO PORTLAND



Portland

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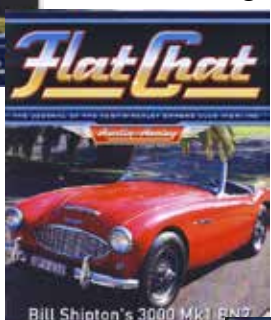
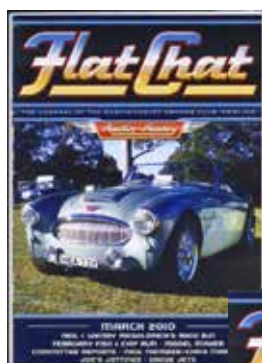
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through to May 2023.

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along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



The Project - Snippet One

By Ian Richter

It begins!

After the euphoria of dragging the BN1 to my shed and whipping off the running gear, reality stepped in. Don't get me wrong; I was fully aware of the effort required to restore a BN1 from 1954 that's been left, (forty-nine years ago) to languish rusting away in the back of a shed. I took this project on as something I would enjoy, and I will enjoy building up this restoration. It's now been a few months and it's my spare time project. Is it progressing too slowly? Some days it feels unachievable, and I have on more than one occasion, second-guessed my choice of starting this project.

This is where an attitude shift was required. Two words I'm sure are well known by all those that have completed or are undertaking a restoration - Persistence and Endurance. Persistence is defined as "continuance till the end", and endurance as "the ability to withstand hardship or adversity, to sustain a prolonged effort". The difference between the two is that persistence is remaining steady in the hope of finishing, while endurance is bearing the pain so that you will finish. Many before me have faced the restoration challenge. This project was never going to be all done and shiny in six months. It's going to be more like years.

Sharing my progress with the *Flat Chat* readers encourages me to get something completed over time. These snippets, a few pictures, a few words now and then are to keep me on track, little incremental movements forward.

The chassis is the focus for now. Get the foundation correct, and everything builds upon it. This sounds simple enough. This BN1 chassis is fairly good, the rails are straight, but there is work to do. It will take me a few months to complete the chassis. There was rust in a couple of places along the centre brace or "cruciform". Now cut out and replaced with a new repair piece from Kilmartins. A note from wizard



Colin Rule, when repairing or replacing the cruciform with the chassis flipped over, take the tension or slight bow out of the chassis by supporting the chassis mid-way. Weld in your repairs, release the centre support, and the chassis will remain straight. Also completed was the repair of the rear chassis crossmember. It was bent like a banana and looking at the damage, I'd say the old bottle jack was used more than once to lift the back end of this Austin-Healey.



Project cont'

I wish that there was more work completed in the last few months, but there wasn't. I took a lot of time looping around the car, planning my attack, or was it squandering time? I'm not certain.

Until the next update, Ian.



Hang on; I'm not quite finished.

An interesting find; On the removing the front suspension inner wishbone arms, the original front bushes were still in place. These were manufactured by Metalastik.

The company was founded in Leicester, UK, in 1937; Metalastik designed, developed and manufactured rubber-to-metal bonded components. They supplied pretty much all of the British motor industry across the '40s through to the '80s and became part of Dunlop Rubber Company in 1958.

It's a nice detail on originality, but they do need to go into the bin. Some replacement parts in the market look similar, although the replacement miss out



on the fancy manufacturer's name and part number stamped on the metal sleeve. Note the Metalastik advert from 1952. My bushes look just like the last illustration.



SHAKE you

The refinement of the present day high performance car owes a lot to 'floating power' (pioneered in this country by Metalastik) and other vibration-damping devices.

The illustrations show some of these components:

1. Front engine mounting (sandwich type).
2. Front engine mounting (interleaved circular mounting).
3. 'Metacone' engine-mounting.
4. Metalastik torsional-vibration damper.
5. Metalastik patent ultra-duty pre-loaded bush.
6. Metalastik bonded-cone bushes for I.F.S.
7. Metalastik axial snubber bush.

METALASTIK

METALASTIK LTD., LEICESTER

Scenes of the BMC Competitions Department



Scenes cont'



Seven tips for cleaning old car parts

by Kyle Smith

Thank you to Hagerty.co.uk

Of all the unsexy projects and tasks that make up the – sometimes painful – steps of any project or restoration, cleaning the parts and pieces while everything is apart probably tops the list of least fun tasks. It's a necessary evil though and a little attention to detail at this point goes a very long way in the final result. There is no sense in "saving time" by leaving everything dirty and dealing with grease and grime working its way back into places it shouldn't be and causing you to do the task twice.



Cleaning can be simple as wiping off some gunk and as involved as soaking a bunch of little parts in a solution overnight before a thorough scrubbing. Regardless of how deep you need to clean, here are seven tips that will make sure your final product is one to be proud of.



One - Start soft

Start with the easiest and safest form of cleaning first. This often means a wipe with a clean towel or rag to see just how bad the situation really is. Sometimes just a clean rag is enough to remove everything that needs to go and leave the surface in acceptable condition. If it isn't, it will at least tell you just how bad it is and what the right course of action might be.



Two - Glove up

Nitrile gloves keep you from soaking up solvents and oils into your skin. 7mm thick offer a sweet spot of durability and affordability.

This isn't an article about safety, but it bears reminding all you DIYers that many chemicals used in automotive processes are hazardous and may be damaging to the human body – and it might not be immediately evident. For example, a common cleaning hack is to use brake cleaner to remove oily residue, but it is also absorbed by the skin and carried in the bloodstream to the liver where it sits, and sits and sits. Our organs cannot process chemicals like carb or brake cleaner and therefore it just accumulates and can cause long-term health issues. Disposable nitrile gloves keep fluids and chemicals from being absorbed and while they can be inconvenient at times, it's better than doing yourself harm.



Three - Use the right stuff

There is a wide range of chemicals on the shelves of your local car parts store that claim to remove the nasty grime with a spray and rinse process. Sometimes those work easily, other times it causes chaos. While they may remove grease they can leave residue on aluminum surfaces and cause corrosion if not rinsed thoroughly.

Clean cont'

The same goes for rubber pieces. Warm water and a light detergent are often the best solution to prevent rubber from distorting, discolouring, or being attacked by aggressive solvents. On the other side oven cleaner can work miracles on cast iron pieces that have tons of baked-on grease and can only be chipped away with aggressive wire brushes before a water rinse. Match the product and process to your material for best results.



Four - Be careful with your finish

Steel wool can be less aggressive than you might think, and works great in a lot of places. A key thing to bear in mind when cleaning old car parts is finish you want on the surface. If you are covering the part it might not be a big deal that there are some scrub marks or a less than perfect surface finish. If you are painting or polishing the piece though, suddenly you want to exercise a lot of caution while cleaning so that any marks that happen during cleaning don't pop through or create more work to remove later.

A steel wire brush on soft aluminium is a prime example of something that can wreak havoc quickly. Plastic or brass bristles are much softer and will prevent scoring or damaging the finish and save you work in the end despite taking a little longer to actually remove grease and grime. Even a green Scotch-Brite pad can be too much for some rubber pieces, so be sure to check in an inconspicuous area to see if your abrasive material will leave its mark or not.

Five - Hide the evidence

Dry or wet blasting are easier than ever with home kits available which are affordable enough that it's not out of the ordinary for someone doing enough restoration work to make the investment in a cabinet. The key to remember if you are so lucky is to make sure to blow or rinse out all the blasting media from the nooks and crannies of whatever gets cleaned up. Having that sand, walnut shell, aluminium oxide, or glass bead pop out while painting or assembling is frustrating at best and damaging at worst.



Six - Careful with the tags

Tape flags work perfect for keeping track of wires, but some solvents will wash away the marker or eat the tape itself.

It's important to not ruin the proper bagging and tagging of all the parts and pieces you did during disassembly when you go to clean everything up. If you have tags, make sure they stay legible or transfer them after the cleaning is completed, piece by piece. If there are adjustments that you have to remove to fully get something clean – think carburetor adjustment screws or adjustable suspension components – be sure to document the adjustment so you can use it as a ballpark during reassembly.

Seven - Under pressure leads to failure

As tempting as it is to toss a gearbox, rear axle or motorcycle in the boot of your car and take it to a jet wash where the high pressure nozzle can blast away the grease and grime, proceed with caution. Many of the gaskets are not made to withstand the high pressure pinpointed in one little area and can quickly fail and allow water and soap to flood inside and cause rust, corrosion, or leaks from the damaged gasket.

If a soap-and-water wash is required often the best course of action is to use nothing more than household hose water pressure. That pressure is low enough that it should be safe for gaskets and seals while still getting things clean.

While tedious and oft annoying, cleaning your project will make for a much more satisfying assembly. Take the time to make every project something worth showing off and being proud of and it will elevate your DIY confidence far more than you might realise.



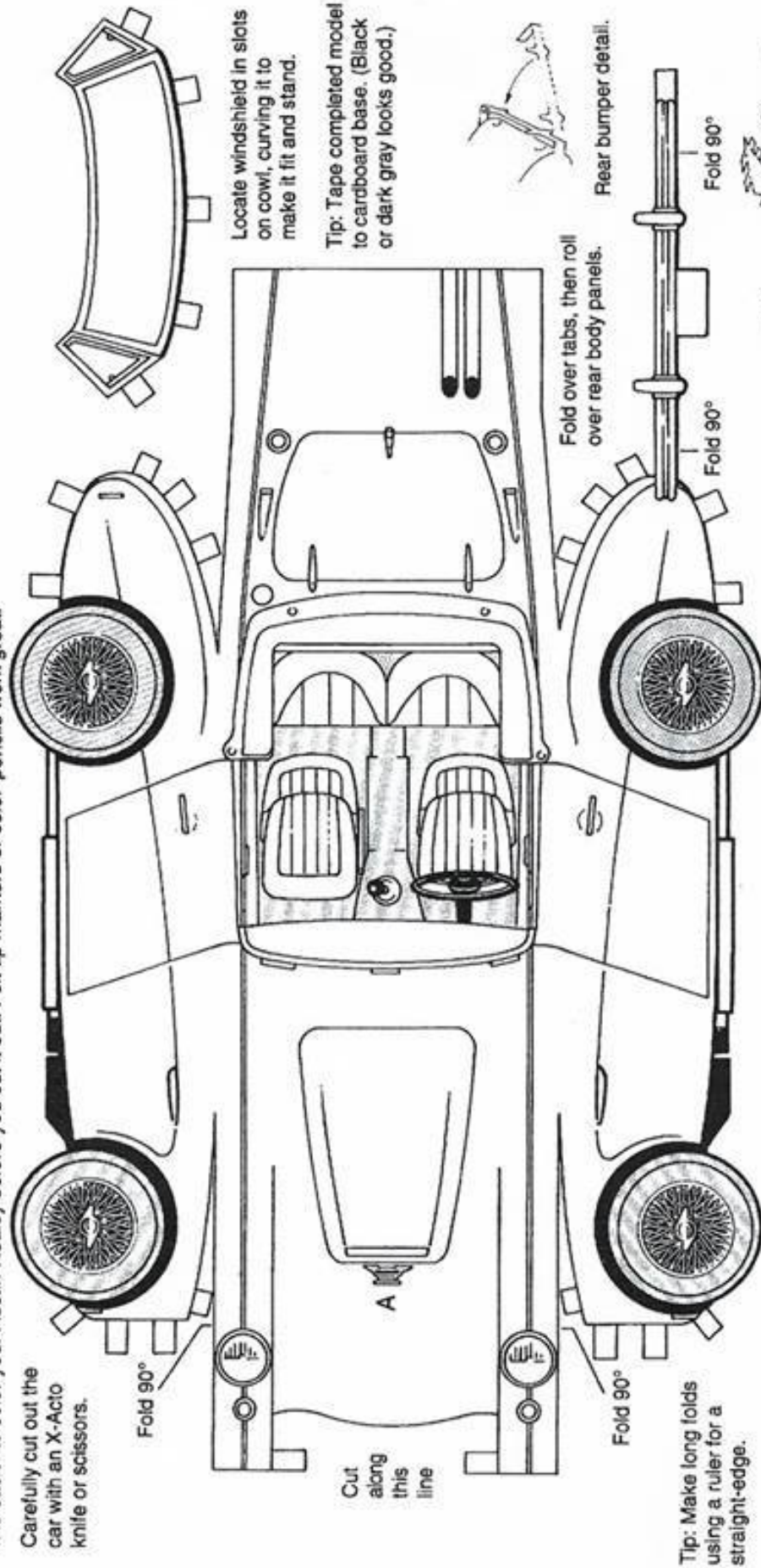
Moss Motors, Ltd. British Sports Car Collection

Austin-Healey 3000 BJT Mk II

One of the last of the Big Healey models, the 3000 Mk II BJT was produced in 1962 and 1963. While not as rare as the Mk II BN7, (only 355 were made) the final number of BJTs totalled only 6113.

It is easier to color your Austin-Healey before you cut it out. Felt tip markers or color pencils work great.

Carefully cut out the car with an X-Acto knife or scissors.



Locate windshield in slots on cowl, curving it to make it fit and stand.

Tip: Tape completed model to cardboard base. (Black or dark gray looks good.)



Rear bumper detail.

1.- Side view of cut-out grille/bumper.

2.- Cut top of overrider. Fold bumper 90° down.

3.- Fold inner fenders 90° up.

4.- Fold grill top to match curvature of hood.

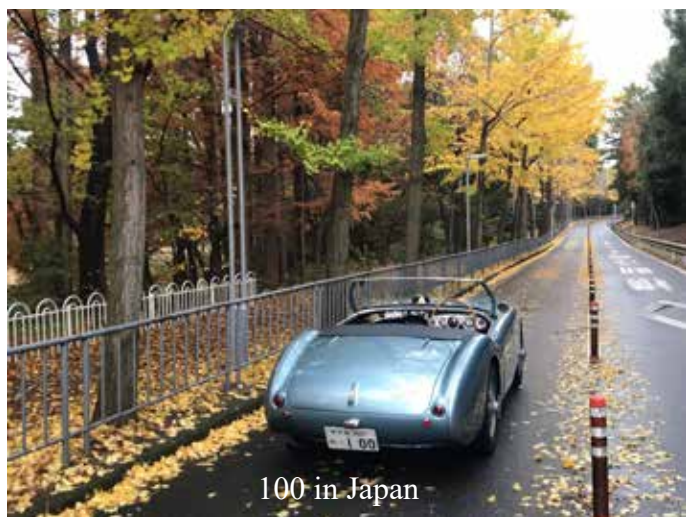
5.- Fold front and top tabs out. Fold bottom tabs in. Next, fold bumper ends 90° back and fit into slots in front fenders.

6.- When you're finished folding, you should end up with a piece that looks like this. Fitting this part is tricky! The inner fenders are a tight fit and you may not need to tape/glue all the tabs.

Grille/bumper

Your Last Page

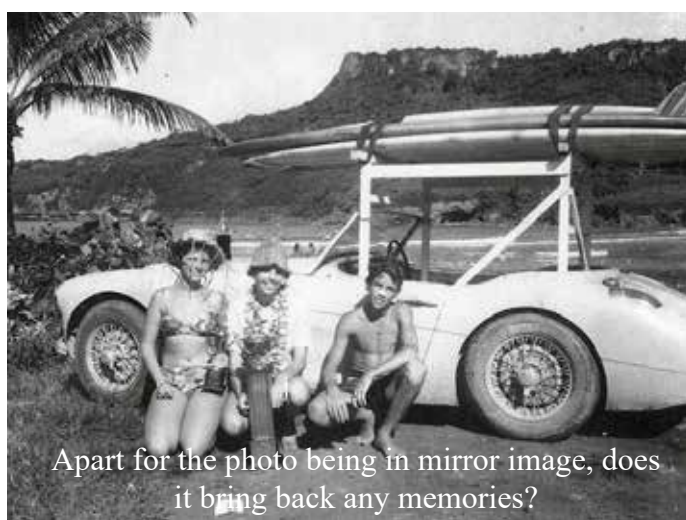
A very easy Spot the Austin-Healey, but what about the Triumph TR4.



100 in Japan



Will you tell him or should I that his side flashes are on the wrong side?



Apart for the photo being in mirror image, does it bring back any memories?

Tools Explained



TWO-TON ENGINE HOIST:
A tool for testing the maximum tensile strength of everything you forgot to disconnect.

Monthly Meetings

Except for May, we meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm